CLEARRUN · SRUJANA TECH FEST 2026 · FINANCE THEME

How ClearRun addresses F-03: predictive cash-flow management for small businesses

A small business can be profitable on paper and still run out of cash, because customers pay late while salaries, rent and suppliers must be paid on time. ClearRun gives the owner an early warning and the tools to act on it.

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The problem as we understood it

Who

Small B2B businesses, such as manufacturers, distributors and traders, that sell on credit to other businesses. Customers often pay weeks after the due date.

What goes wrong

Owners track cash in their heads or in spreadsheets. They find out about a cash gap when it arrives, chase payments by hand, and give credit by gut feel.

We narrowed the problem to four questions an owner asks every week, and built one tool for each:

The owner's question	What ClearRun gives them
1. Will I run short, and when?	A 13-week cash forecast with what-if sliders, plus a simulation of 1,500 possible futures that shows the *chance* of falling below a safe reserve or below zero.
2. Who owes me money, and how do I get paid faster?	Invoice tracking with photo and PDF scanning, and an automatic reminder ladder: gentle, then formal, then a legal notice, with MSMED Act interest included for registered MSEs.
3. Should I give this customer credit?	A customer risk score built from real payment behaviour, and a deal checker that suggests credit days, an advance or a cheque, and says when the money will really arrive.
4. Can my team work on this together?	Shared workspaces through invite codes, Google sign-in, and saving that keeps everyone's changes.

Where the "predictive" part comes from

Forecast

Cash position over time

Opening cash plus expected receipts minus planned bills, week by week, compared with the owner's reserve.

Simulation

Chance of a shortfall

1,500 simulated versions of the 13 weeks, with realistic variation in when customer money arrives, give a probability rather than a single guess.

Behaviour

When customers will really pay

Each customer's typical and bad-case delay, learned from their paid invoices, predicts real arrival dates and powers the deal advice.

The forecast and the risk score use plain arithmetic, not machine learning. Small businesses rarely have enough history to train a model, and an owner is more likely to act on a number they can understand. The AI part, invoice reading, is checked by fixed rules before anything reaches the forecast.

From early warning to action

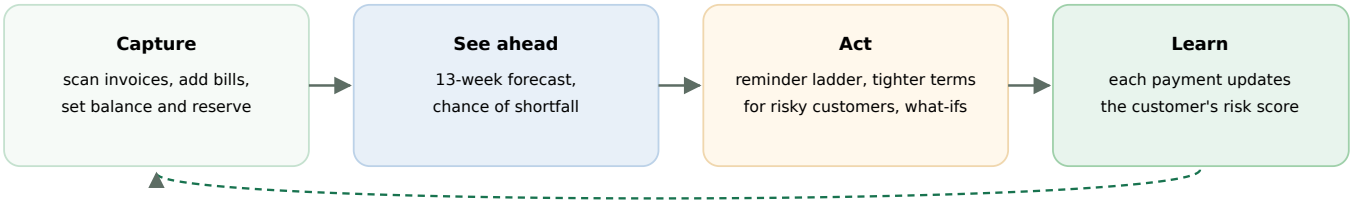


Figure 1. The loop ClearRun supports. Every payment that comes in makes the next prediction better.

Getting paid: the reminder ladder

Tier	When	Tone
Gentle	7 days before due; on the due date	Friendly. Assumes it is an oversight and offers a copy of the invoice.
Formal	7 and 15 days overdue	Firm. States the amount and days overdue and asks for a payment date. At 15 days it adds an estimate of MSMED Act interest if the seller is Udyam-registered.
Legal notice	30 days overdue	A formal demand notice with a reference number and a 15-day deadline. For Udyam-registered sellers it refers to Section 18 (the MSE Facilitation Council). It is sent only if the owner approves it for that invoice, and it can also be printed.

Each email goes out under the business's name and at most once per step. Reminders stop as soon as the invoice is marked received. The legal notice is a template, not legal advice.

A two-minute walkthrough for judges

1. Open the demo with no account needed, and look at the 13-week forecast and the reserve line.
2. Move the *delay a customer payment* slider and watch the *chance of going below reserve* rise.
3. Go to **Invoices** and open the **Reminder ladder** for Delta Traders, which is 38 days overdue. The gentle steps are skipped, a formal reminder goes next, and the legal notice waits for approval.
4. Go to **Customer risk**. Delta Traders is "Advance only", and the reasons explain why. Check a ₹1,20,000 deal and add the suggested payments to the forecast.
5. Sign in with Google, scan a real invoice, and see the fields that need checking highlighted in amber.

What makes this approach fit small businesses

- **Little typing.** Scanning fills in invoices, and payment history builds up from invoices already entered.
- **Explainable.** Every risk score lists its reasons, and every forecast number can be traced back to an entry.
- **Built for India.** Amounts in lakh and crore, day-first dates, GSTIN checks, and MSMED Act interest and notice wording.
- **Safe by default.** Reminders run in test mode until switched on, the legal notice needs approval, and the user reviews scans before they are saved.

Limits and next steps

Today	Next
Bank balance entered by hand	Connect bank data through India's Account Aggregator framework, with the owner's consent
Invoices scanned or typed one by one	Import from Tally, Zoho Books and GST e-invoices
Same timing variation for every customer in the simulation	Use each customer's own delay pattern from the risk model
Reminders by email	WhatsApp reminders, which many small business customers read first
Risk model checked only against the Python original	Measure prediction accuracy on real payment history from pilot businesses